

Feature Brainstorming — Additional Metrics for College Admin Dashboard

Context

Discussion initiated to identify meaningful and operationally useful metrics for the college admin/dean dashboard of the student preparation platform.

Primary objective:

Provide institutional stakeholders with clear visibility into:

- student adoption
- engagement quality
- intervention needs
- overall preparation outcomes

without overwhelming them with excessive analytics complexity.

Initial Exploration

Initially explored several common SaaS/product metrics such as:

- DAU/WAU
- session duration
- retention ratios
- engagement scores
- feature depth metrics
- activity ratios

However, it was realized that many of these:

- overlap conceptually
- create cognitive overload
- are difficult for institutional users to interpret
- do not naturally imply action

Important realization:

The dashboard should optimize for operational decision-making, not analytical richness.

Key Insight About Institutional Users

College admins/deans are:

- outcome-oriented
- operationally focused
- unlikely to interpret advanced analytics frequently

Therefore, metrics should:

- be immediately understandable
 - naturally suggest action
 - avoid hidden scoring systems
 - remain explainable
-

Important Strategic Discussion — Intervention Logic

Initially, intervention metrics included all low-activity students.

Problem identified:

In many Indian college environments, a large number of students may remain permanently disengaged from career preparation activities.

Including all such students would:

- inflate intervention counts
- reduce dashboard signal quality
- create operationally unrealistic intervention scope

This led to a distinction between:

1. permanently disinterested students
 2. interested but inconsistent/underperforming students
-

Additional Refinement — Optional Platform Participation

A major shift happened after introducing the fact that platform participation is optional rather than mandatory.

Key realization:

Registration itself becomes an intent signal.

Therefore:

Inactive or declining activity among opted-in students becomes meaningful and intervention-worthy.

This significantly improved the quality of intervention metrics.

Final Conclusion

Four important aspects were finalized for the dashboard:

1. Visibility

Metric

Weekly Active Users

Purpose:

Understand whether students are actively using the platform on a recurring basis.

Status:

Already present in the current dashboard.

2. Accountability

Metric

Department-wise usage/utilization

Purpose:

Identify departments with weak adoption or low engagement.

Possible representations:

- separate department usage view
- comparative visualization (bar graph)

Observation:
Separate view already exists.
Comparative visualization can improve institutional visibility.

3. Intervention

Metric

Students needing attention

Purpose:
Identify students showing signs of disengagement or declining performance.

Logic:
Rule-based filtering instead of opaque scoring systems.

Possible rules:

- declining mock performance
- long disengagement/inactivity

UI Direction:
Dashboard card displaying:

- number of students requiring attention
- CTA for escalation/intervention
(likely faculty notification/escalation flow)

Important realization:
Intervention metrics become meaningful because platform participation itself reflects student intent.

4. Outcome Tracking

Metric

Students performing quality activity above threshold

Purpose:
Measure meaningful preparation effort instead of generic activity.

Examples of quality activity:

- mock interviews
- assessments
- preparation sessions
- meaningful preparation workflows

Suggested representation:

- dashboard card
- count + percentage

Possible evaluation window:

Monthly threshold tracking.

Key insight:

“Active” alone is weak.

“Meaningfully active” is a much stronger institutional outcome signal.

Final Learnings

- Simpler operational metrics are more valuable than analytics-heavy dashboards.
 - Metrics should naturally imply action.
 - Explainable rule-based systems are preferable over abstract engagement scores.
 - Opt-in participation significantly improves signal quality for engagement and intervention metrics.
 - Measuring meaningful preparation activity is more valuable than measuring raw platform usage.
-

Future Considerations

- Stronger output oriented metrics that can help colleges monitor growth of overall students in a certain regular interval based on the assessments.
- Students grievance redressal metric to identify the satisfaction of students on grievance redressal.